Union by saying these issues were of concern to no one except the Soviet Union:

Dear Mr. President:

Your letter of December 7, transmitted through Secretary Baldrige, addressed questions on which we had a rather thorough discussion in Geneva. At that time, I outlined in detail our approach to these questions, and, it seemed to me, you took in what was said with certain understanding.

It is hardly necessary to repeat, that the questions involved pertain to the internal competence of our state and that they are resolved in strict conformity with the laws. I would like only to point out, the Soviet laws do not create impediments when decisions are taken on the questions of departure from the USSR by Soviet citizens who have legal grounds for that. . . the existing laws are obligatory to everybody—both to those who apply to leave and those who consider exit applications. Such is the essence of our law and order and nobody is entitled to violate it—whether under any pressure or without it. I should think that should be understood in the U.S. We, of course, take into account, that due to various circumstances, divided families appear, which live partially in the USSR and partially in the USA. Only in the past five years there have been over 400 marriages between Soviet and American citizens. The overwhelming majority of those marriages —to be precise, more than 95 per cent—encountered no problems in regard to the reunification of the spouses and to living together. Yes, there are exceptions, and we have frankly and repeatedly told you what they are about. But generally, and I want to stress it once again, questions of this kind are resolved